

PETITION

Middleton-Cross Plains Area School District

Board Seat Allocation Reform – Hybrid Representation Model

Filed pursuant to Wis. Stat. §120.02 | For vote at the 2026 MCPASD Annual Meeting

We, the undersigned qualified electors of the Middleton-Cross Plains Area School District, pursuant to Wisconsin Statute §120.02, respectfully petition the Board of Education to adopt a hybrid board seat allocation model as follows: **five (5) designated seats**, one per geographic attendance area (Areas I through V), requiring residency in that area; and **four (4) at-large seats**, open to any district resident. All seats shall continue to be elected district-wide. Excess seats in Areas II and IV shall convert to at-large as terms expire, beginning with the April 2027 election, consistent with the model used by the Verona Area School District.

Transition Plan: Area IV (currently 4 seats) reduces to 1 designated seat; Area II (currently 2 seats) reduces to 1 designated seat. Excess seats convert to at-large as terms expire: 2027 (2 seats convert), 2028 (1 seat), 2029 (1 seat). End state: 5 area + 4 at-large = 9 total.

We request this petition be presented for consideration and vote at the 2026 MCPASD Annual Meeting, and upon adoption, that the Board implement the transition beginning with the April 2027 election.

SIGNATURES OF QUALIFIED ELECTORS (Minimum 500 required per Wis. Stat. §120.02)

By signing below, I affirm that I am a qualified elector of the Middleton-Cross Plains Area School District and that I support this petition.

#	Print Name	Signature	Municipality	Street Address	Date
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CERTIFICATION OF CIRCULATOR (Required on each sheet – Wis. Stat. §8.40)

I, _____, certify that I personally circulated this petition and personally obtained each of the signatures on this page; that I know each signer is a qualified elector of the Middleton-Cross Plains Area School District; that I know each signer signed this petition with full knowledge of its content; that I know the residence of each signer as given is accurate; that I know each signer signed on the date stated opposite their name; that I am a qualified elector of the State of Wisconsin; and that I am aware that falsifying this certification is punishable under Wis. Stat. §12.13(3)(a).

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Page ____ of ____

HOW SEATS CONVERT: 2026–2029 TRANSITION

CURRENT BOARD (9 seats – all area-designated)

Area	Seats	Members	Term Expires
I	1	Emily Evans	2028
II	2	Bob Green Catherine Kells	2027 2026
III	1	Tabitha Hansen	2028
IV	4	Katie Frank Robert Hesselbein Marni Ginsberg Jim Coursey	2027 2028 2026 2026
V	1	Kemper Durand	2027

▼ TRANSITION ▼

Election Year	What Happens	Area IV Seats	Area II Seats	At-Large Seats
2026	Ginsberg & Coursey re-elected Area IV; Kells re-elected Area II (current rules)	4	2	0
2027	Frank seat (IV) → At-Large #1 Green seat (II) → At-Large #2	3	1	2
2028	Hesselbein seat (IV) → At-Large #3	2	1	3
2029	Ginsberg OR Coursey seat (IV) → At-Large #4	1	1	4

▼ END STATE (2029+) ▼

Seat Type	Count	Residency Requirement	Who Votes
Area I	1	Must live in Area I	All district voters
Area II	1	Must live in Area II	All district voters
Area III	1	Must live in Area III	All district voters
Area IV	1	Must live in Area IV	All district voters
Area V	1	Must live in Area V	All district voters
At-Large	4	Any district resident	All district voters
TOTAL	9		

VERONA AREA SCHOOL DISTRICT COMPARISON

Verona ASD (7 members): 3 “portion” seats with geographic residency + 4 at-large seats. All elected district-wide. This model has been operating successfully in our neighboring district.

KEY POINTS

- ✓ No incumbent is forced out – seats convert only as terms expire
- ✓ Every area keeps guaranteed representation (1 seat each)
- ✓ More opportunity for qualified candidates from anywhere in the district
- ✓ All voters continue to vote on all seats (no change to voting)

✓ Proven model already in use at neighboring Verona ASD

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